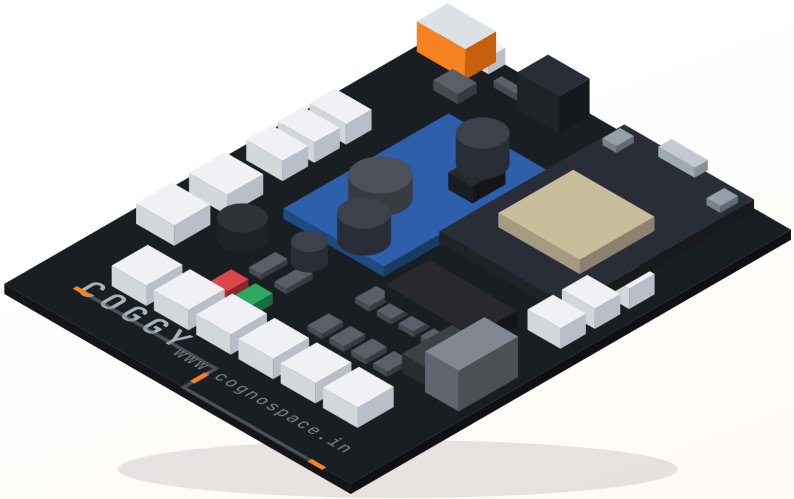
CognoSpace®
Experiential Learning

COGNOSPACE FLASHER · SETUP GUIDE

Install the USB drivers on Windows

Most computers find the Coggy straight away. If yours doesn't show up when you press **Connect Coggy**, this guide gets it working in about five minutes.

7 steps | About 5 minutes | Windows 10 & 11



What you need

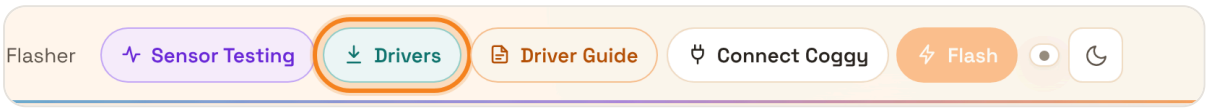
- A Coggy board
- A USB **data** cable (some cables only charge)
- A Windows computer with Chrome or Edge
- Permission to install software on the computer

Do I need this?

- The port list is empty after you press Connect Coggy
- The Coggy shows as "Unknown device" in Device Manager
- You only install the drivers once per computer

1 Click Drivers in the Flasher navbar

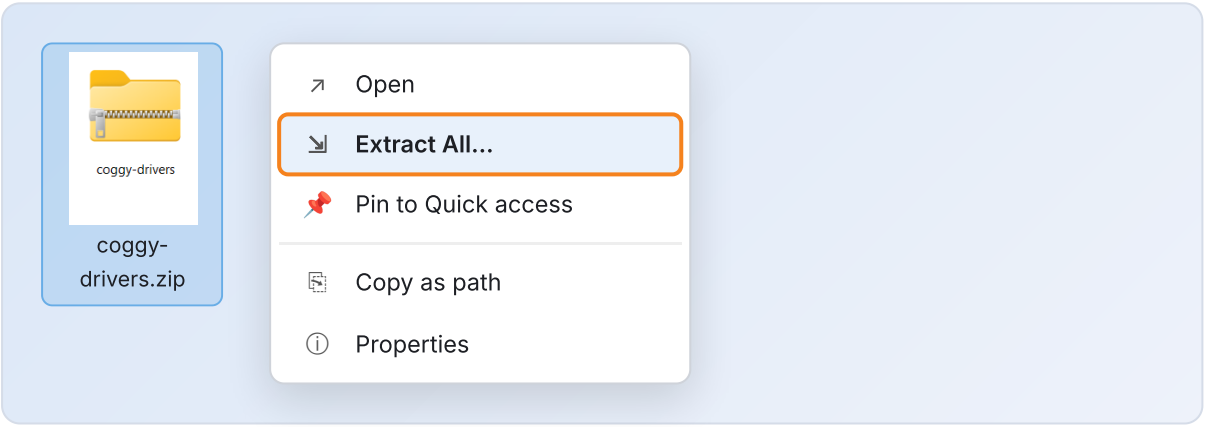
Open the CognoSpace Flasher website in Chrome or Edge. In the bar along the top of the page, click the green **Drivers** button. The download starts straight away.



On a small window the button shows only its ↓ icon.

2 Find `coggy-drivers.zip` in Downloads

Open File Explorer and go to your **Downloads** folder, or click the file in your browser's download list. It's a zipped folder, so Windows shows it with a zip on the icon.



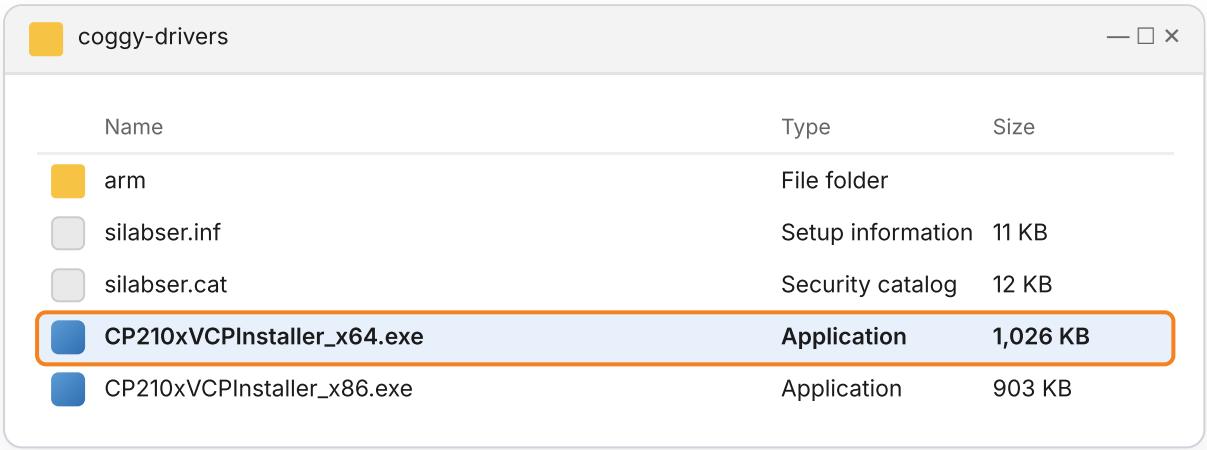
3 Right-click it and choose Extract All...

The installer won't run from inside the zip, so unzip it first. Right-click `coggy-drivers.zip`, choose **Extract All...**, then click **Extract**. Windows creates a normal folder called `coggy-drivers` next to the zip and opens it.

> **Tip:** keep this folder. If Windows Update ever swaps the driver out, you can run the installer again from here.

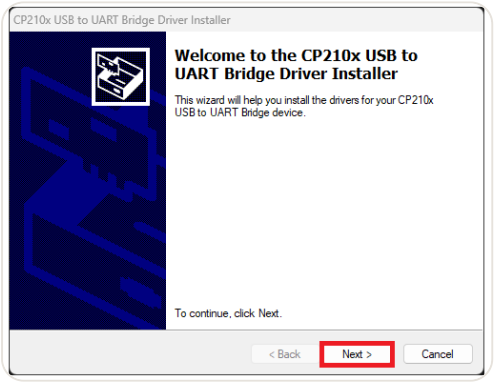
4 Double-click the installer for your PC

Inside the folder you'll see a few files. Almost every computer today is 64-bit, so double-click `CP210xVCPInstaller_x64.exe`. Use the `_x86` one only on an older 32-bit PC. If Windows asks *"Do you want to allow this app to make changes?"*, click **Yes**.

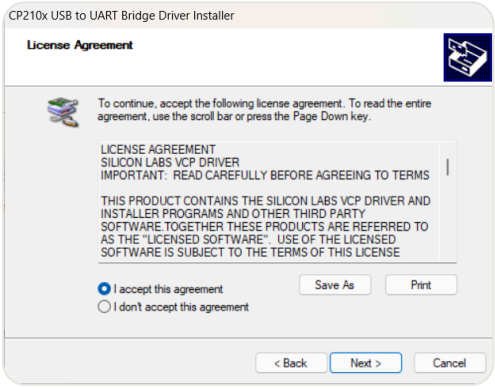


5 Click through the installer, then Finish

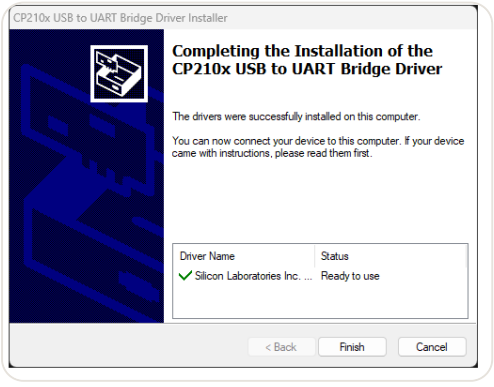
Click **Next**, select **I accept this agreement**, and click **Next** again. When it says the drivers were installed, click **Finish**.



1 Click **Next**



2 Accept, then **Next**

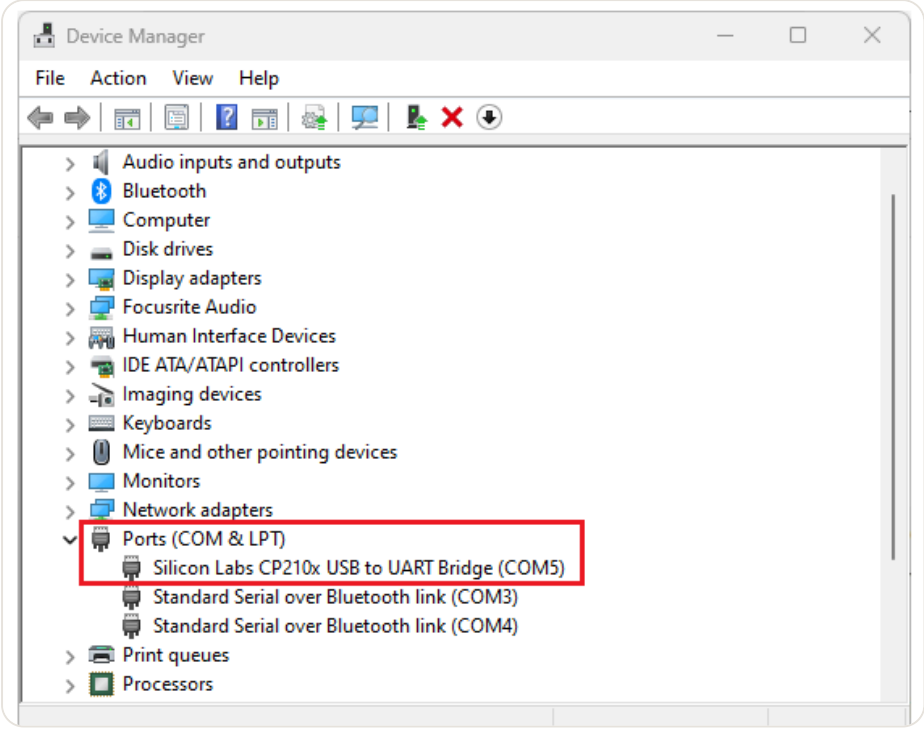


3 "Ready to use", click **Finish**

> **Now unplug the Coggy and plug it back in**, so Windows picks up the new driver.

6 Check the Coggy in Device Manager

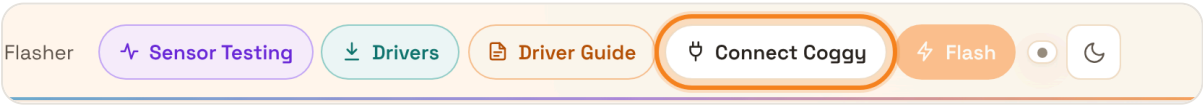
With the Coggy plugged in, click the Windows **Search** box, type `Device Manager` and open it. Expand **Ports (COM & LPT)**. You should see **Silicon Labs CP210x USB to UART Bridge (COM*x*)**. The number varies from PC to PC; it was COM5 in the example below.

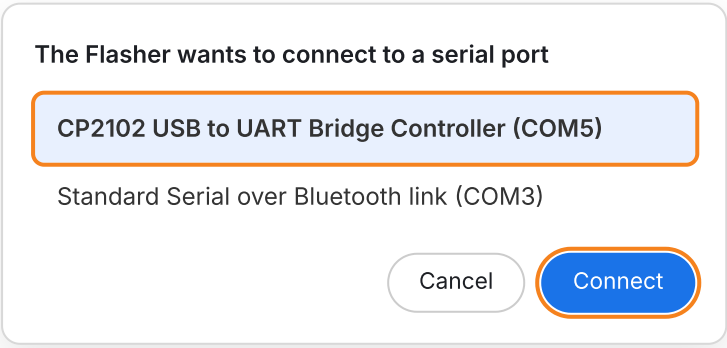


No Ports section, or a yellow warning sign? See “If something goes wrong” on the next page.

7 Connect in the Flasher

Back on the Flasher website, click **Connect Coggy**. Your browser lists the ports it can see. Pick the **CP210x** entry and click **Connect**. The button changes to **Disconnect** and the light next to **Flash** turns green. You’re ready to flash.





The exact wording comes from your browser and the driver, so it may read slightly differently. Look for **CP210x** or **CP2102** and the same COM number you saw in Device Manager.

If something goes wrong

Most problems come down to the cable, the port or a driver that Windows replaced. Try these in order.

? No Ports section at all

Plug the Coggy in **before** opening Device Manager. The port only appears while the board is connected. Try a different USB socket on the computer too.

? Still nothing appears

The cable may be charge-only, which has no data wires. Swap it for a cable you know carries data, such as one used to sync a phone.

? Yellow warning sign or Code 10 / 31

Right-click the device, choose **Uninstall device**, unplug the Coggy, run the installer from step 4 again, then plug it back in.

? It worked yesterday, not today

Windows Update sometimes swaps in its own driver. Run the installer again from the `coggy-drivers` folder you kept in step 3.

? Shows as “USB-SERIAL CH340”

Some boards use a different USB chip. If the device name mentions **CH340**, that board needs the CH340 driver instead. Ask us and we’ll point you to it.

? Port shows, but Connect fails

Close anything else using the port, like the Arduino IDE serial monitor or another Flasher tab. Hold **Shift** while pressing Connect Coggy to see every port.

? “Can’t open the zip”

Make sure the download finished. The file should be `coggy-drivers.zip`, not `.crdownload`. Click Drivers again if it didn’t.

? Installer is blocked

School and office PCs often need an administrator to install drivers. Ask your IT team to run step 4 once. It covers every student on that PC.



That’s it, you only do this once.

From now on, plug in the Coggy, press **Connect Coggy**, and flash any activity in about thirty seconds. Still stuck? Ask Sparky, the helper on the Flasher site, or write to the CognoSpace team.